

Palace of Versailles

Louis XVI lived in splendor in the huge Palace of Versailles, near Paris. In October 1789, thousands of starving women marched from Paris to Versailles because bread prices were too high.

European revolution

France is in Europe. At the time of the revolution, it was surrounded by countries still ruled by kings and queens.



KEY



France before the revolution



Areas taken over by revolutionary France



Main sites of the revolution

People overthrew their leaders across France.



Guillotine sites

A machine called the guillotine was used to behead many enemies of the revolution.

ENGLISH CHANNEL

French army

The French army invaded Belgium in 1792, to fight an attack from Austria, Prussia, and Britain.

Paris

Versailles

Strasbourg

Execution of Louis XVI

Fall of the Bastille

On July 14, 1789, a Parisian mob attacked the Bastille prison, which was a symbol of the government's power.

On September 21, 1792, Louis XVI was overthrown. He was guillotined (beheaded) on January 21, 1793.

Nantes

General Charette led thousands of people in the Vendée region against the revolution in 1793.

General Charette

Bordeaux

Marseille

SCALE

0 200 miles
0 200 kilometers

A three-colored flag

On February 15, 1794, France adopted a three-colored flag called the "tricolore." The colors are sometimes said to stand for liberty (freedom), equality (being treated the same), and fraternity (brotherhood).



Napoleon Bonaparte, in the 1800s

Napoleon Bonaparte

In 1799, a brilliant French army general called Napoleon (1769–1821) overthrew the new government. He crowned himself emperor of France in 1804. Napoleon conquered most of Europe, before being defeated by Britain and Prussia in 1815.

French Revolution

In 1789, many people in France were starving. They rose up against their king, Louis XVI, and his government. In 1792, the French people set up a republic, which meant they could choose how France was ruled. King Louis and thousands of his supporters were killed.